

Yang-Jun Joo, Ph.D.

Data Scientist | Quantitative Risk Assessment

Autonomous Vehicle Safety | Statistical & Probabilistic Modeling | Large-Scale Driving Data

Orlando, FL | Open to relocation to Foster City, CA

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Professional Summary: Quantitative risk assessment data scientist with 8+ years of research and applied project experience, including 3+ years of post-Ph.D. experience, developing probabilistic safety metrics, uncertainty-aware models, and automated risk assessment tools for autonomous vehicle systems. Author/co-author of 15 peer-reviewed papers and PI on two competitively funded safety projects, with hands-on experience in Python, SQL, multi-terabyte driving data, and human behavior data analysis.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming & Data:	Python, SQL, R, pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn, PyTorch, Git, Linux, ETL and analytics pipelines.
Risk & Statistics:	Probabilistic modeling, Bayesian networks, reliability analysis, surrogate safety measures, regression, treatment-effect analysis, uncertainty quantification, conformal prediction.
Safety & Mobility:	Risk-assessment frameworks, safety-performance metrics, AV safety evaluation, naturalistic driving video, connected-vehicle and trajectory data, traffic-conflict analysis, human factors.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Postdoctoral Scholar (Quantitative Safety Analytics)	University of Central Florida	Mar 2024 – Present
• Led quantitative safety workstreams for the Florida Department of Transportation (FDOT), collaborating with agency and technical teams to define, validate, and standardize safety-performance metrics using high-resolution traffic-controller, connected-vehicle, and naturalistic driving data. • Secured KRW 73.5 million in competitive funding and led the project as principal investigator, using causal forests and treatment-effect analysis on responses from 926 participants evaluating 1,325 near-miss clips to quantify heterogeneous effects of vehicle automation on risk perception. • Built and automated Python and SQL ETL and analytics pipelines for multi-terabyte datasets from 1,000+ intersections, standardizing risk-metric generation and reporting. • Developed uncertainty-aware evaluation methods for autonomous-driving vision-language models (VLM) using conformal prediction, identifying context-specific calibration failures in safety-critical driving-scene question answering.		
Postdoctoral Researcher (AV Safety Systems)	Seoul National University	Mar 2023 – Feb 2024
• Led research on real-time infrastructure-to-vehicle (V2I) safety information systems for the Korean National Police Agency, defining safety-critical scenarios and operational safety criteria.		
Graduate Research Assistant	Seoul National University	Mar 2018 – Feb 2023
• Developed generalized quantitative risk assessment methods for autonomous vehicle lane changes and collision avoidance using field theory, Bayesian networks, reliability analysis, and surrogate safety measures. • Secured and led a KRW 96.1 million Global Ph.D. Fellowship, developing and validating probabilistic AV risk-assessment methods for lane changes, collision avoidance, and driver-level crash risk.		

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- Joo et al. (2023), "A Generalized Driving Risk Assessment Method for Autonomous Vehicles Using Field Theory," *Analytic Methods in Accident Research*, 37, 100251.

- Joo et al. (2022), "A Data-Driven Bayesian Network for Probabilistic Crash Risk Assessment of Individual Driver with Traffic Violation and Crash Records," *Accident Analysis & Prevention*, 174, 106721.
- Joo et al. (2026), "Context-Aware Conformal Prediction for VLM-Based Driving Scene QA," *Forty-Third International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML) Workshop EMM-QA*.

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Civil & Environmental Engineering (Transportation), Seoul National University, 2023

B.S., Civil & Environmental Engineering, Seoul National University, 2018